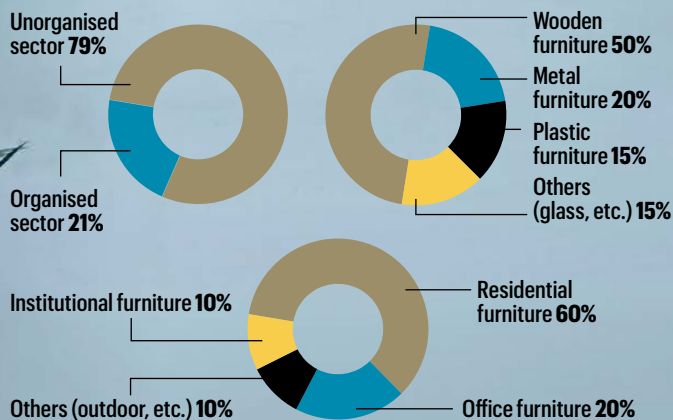


TOUCH WOOD

● The unorganised sector continues to dominate the Indian furniture market, indicating significant growth potential for branded furniture makers in the future



NOTE DATA AS OF JULY 31, 2024

SOURCE MARKETWATCH, DELOITTE, COMPANY REPORTS

when you buy a Rolex, you're not just spending a lot of money on a watch. What you are investing in is a piece of history. When people enter Poltrona's store, they are here not to buy any kind of furniture. You're talking about a piece of history and craftsmanship," Coropulis explains.

Poltrona entered India via a 50:50 joint venture with the Tata group and set up its first business unit in Mumbai. After FDI norms were eased, it bought Tata's stake in 2016. The India unit, which posted revenue of ₹90 crore for calendar year 2023, has since 2016 expanded to Surat, Ahmedabad, Hyderabad, Bengaluru and New Delhi using the dealership model. It plans to expand to Kolkata, Indore, Coimbatore, Chennai, and Chandigarh

over the next few years.

As Coropulis says, Poltrona's design philosophy uniquely aligns with India. The company's aesthetics may be firmly within the modernist style, yet this modernism is married seamlessly with tradition. For instance, the company is known in the industry as a master of leather, it gives its furniture their trademark softness, durability, and natural beauty. But Poltrona also complements this by adding premium materials such as fine wood, metals, and fabric. "Our aesthetics feature clean lines, harmonious proportions, and understated sophistication, making them suitable for both classic and contemporary interiors," he says.

Similarly, Pottery Barn, the San Francisco-based furniture and

home décor brand, entered India in mid-2022 and within two years has already made its presence felt here. Earlier this year, it roped in Bollywood actor Deepika Padukone as its brand ambassador to showcase its timeless home furnishings collection.

Swedish furniture giant IKEA is not far behind either. It is gearing up for its next phase of investment in India, following the full utilisation of its initial commitment of ₹10,500 crore. The company opened its first store in Hyderabad in August 2018 and is presently expanding its footprint in the Delhi-NCR region. The company plans to open stores in Gurugram and Noida by 2025. Currently, it operates in Hyderabad, Mumbai, and Bengaluru.